



# Choose and justify a common denominator

2026-09-29 | Grade 5 | 45 minutes

## Learning focus

Use equivalent fractions to add unlike denominators. Explain calculations and context while recording actual help.

00-05 min

### Recall two valid denominators

Compare two representations of the same fraction and explain their equal value.

05-13 min

### Justify a denominator choice

Model two valid common denominators for a fresh sum. Explain why the smaller convenient denominator is optional.

13-25 min

### Compare methods in pairs

Solve fresh sums using two valid methods. Explain why equivalent unreduced results count as correct.

25-40 min

### Apply the chosen method

Solve short ribbon-length problems with working and units. The teacher records help without supplying a group label.

40-45 min

### Check the reasoning

Write one equivalent-fraction step and explain what the denominator counts.

Review current evidence before changing this plan. The assessment stays fixed on October 2.